

Malvolio is usually stern and cold, so when he smiles continuously at Olivia, she thinks that he has gone crazy

MAGIC AND MISCHIEF

A Midsummer Night's Dream is set in an enchanted wood, home to Oberon and Titania, king and queen of the fairies. Angry with Titania, Oberon asks his servant Puck to drop a love potion in her eyes while she sleeps. It makes her fall in love with the first creature she sees on waking – Bottom, a humble weaver. For his own amusement, Puck has given Bottom the head of an ass.

Malvolio dreams of being made Count Malvolio



Bottom with the head of an ass

Oberon cures Titania with a herb, thought to be wormwood

Wormwood (*Artemisia absinthium*)

Malvolio's name means "bad will"

Malvolio's costume is usually made as farcical as possible for the scene with Olivia



MAKING A GOOD WIFE

This poster advertises the 1929 movie of *The Taming of the Shrew*, the least romantic of Shakespeare's comedies. Petruchio, the hero, decides to marry Katherina for money, not love. Katherina is "renowned in Padua for her scolding tongue." The play shows how Petruchio goes about "taming" Katherina, turning her into an obedient wife.



Petruchio

MAD FOR LOVE

Malvolio, in *Twelfth Night*, is the conceited steward of Olivia, a rich and beautiful countess. Practical jokers send him a letter, supposedly from Olivia. It says that she adores him and commands him to wear yellow stockings with cross garters, and to smile constantly in her presence. Malvolio follows the instructions and ends up being locked in a dark room as a madman.

Malvolio, the central character of the comic subplot in *Twelfth Night*

*"And each several chamber bless
Through this palace with sweet peace;
And the owner of it blessed
Ever shall in safety rest."*

WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE

Oberon in *A Midsummer Night's Dream*



Olivia has sworn to wear a veil for seven years, mourning her dead brother

Olivia